

# Inside the lungs

Packed into your chest are a pair of soft, spongy lungs. Their job is to get oxygen into, and carbon dioxide out of, your blood. This transfer is made possible by millions of tiny air bags inside the lungs that are supplied by a rich network of blood vessels.

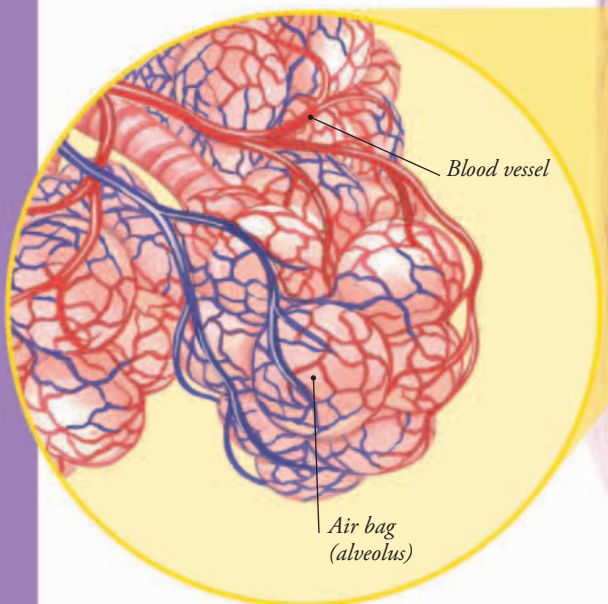
*The trachea carries air to and from the lungs.*

*Blood is carried into the lung by the pulmonary artery.*

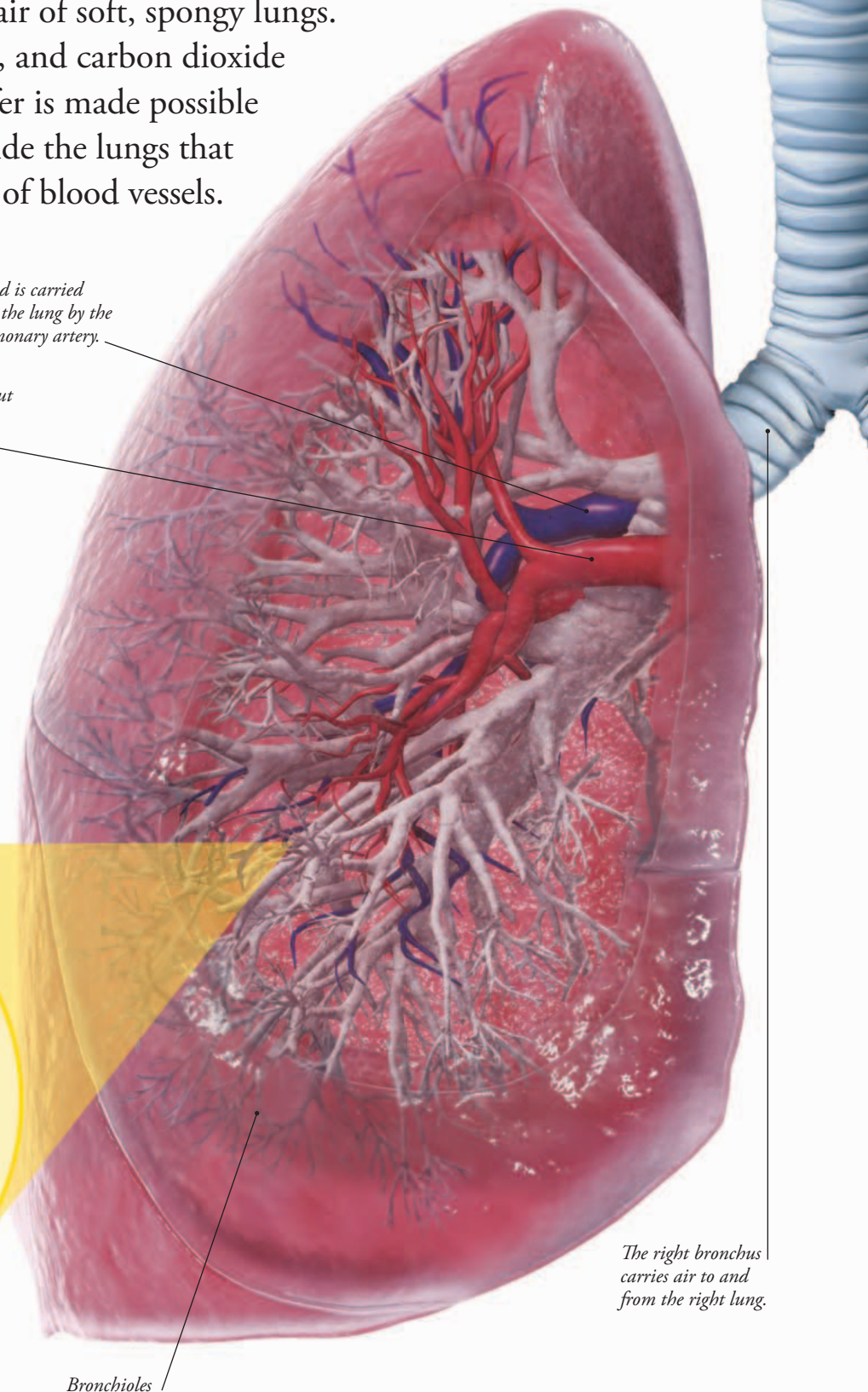
*Blood is carried out of the lung by the pulmonary vein.*

## LUNG STRUCTURE

Air is carried to the lungs by a tube called the trachea. This branches into two tubes called bronchi, which branch further into smaller and smaller tubes called bronchioles. At the end of the tiniest bronchioles are 150 million little air bags, called alveoli, which swap oxygen for carbon dioxide.



▲ **AIR BAGS** The bronchioles end in tiny, lumpy air bags called alveoli. Oxygen from the air inside alveoli passes into the blood capillaries that surround them.



*The right bronchus carries air to and from the right lung.*

*Bronchioles*